

7.1 An Introduction To Macros

Macros let you automate a wide range of tasks, ranging from things like filling in a range with certain values to importing data from other worksheets too. But creating one is simple, even though they can be powerful.

- (a) Think of a task you do often—like changing the font in a range of cells, or entering some formulas in a range of cells.
- (b) Turn on the macro recorder, and perform that task once.
- (c) Assign a shortcut key to the macro.
- (d) Use the shortcut key to run it thereafter.

Macros not only help in speeding up the process of the repetitive task, they're also a good thing because you're sure it'll be done the same way every time you run it, eliminating the possibility of an error on your part.

To create a macro, you can either use the macro recorder, or you can enter the instructions in the VBA Editor. We'll come later to what the VBA Editor is, but just remember that that method requires you to have some programming knowledge. Also, do remember that even when you record a macro using the macro recorder, the code that is generated is in VBA (Visual Basic for Applications). So when you record a macro, you can just go to the VBA editor and check what you've generated. Here's about creating macros using the macro recorder.

7.2 Preparing To Record Macros

Macros that get recorded are stored (as VBA code) in one of three places—as part of the workbook you're using right then, as part of a different workbook (which you can specify), or in a globally accessible workbook called the Personal Macro Workbook. This workbook is called PERSONAL.XLSB, and is in the XLSTART (in C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\Office 12) folder.